

AI: Beyond Python

In this final article of the 12-part series on AI, we will briefly review the topics covered thus far and suggest how to continue improving our skills. Additionally, we will discuss the main topics that were not adequately covered in the series and offer guidance on how to master them. However, the primary focus of this article will be on programming languages, other than Python, that are widely used for developing machine learning-based applications.



As we arrive at the final article in this series on AI and machine learning, I am reminded of a quote by Winston Churchill that aptly applies to the journey of a newcomer introduced to AI through this series: “This is not the end, this is not even the beginning of the end, this is just perhaps the end of the beginning.” While we have covered a great deal in this series and gained valuable knowledge, this is only the start of our journey in the vast ocean of AI. To navigate these challenging waters, we must still acquire a multitude of skills.

Let us begin this final article by taking a moment to review the latest trends in the fields of AI and machine learning.

For a while, there were various online and offline tools that claimed to use AI to perform diverse tasks. However, not many people took these tools seriously. For example, the AI-based image generation model DALL-E 2 has been active since January 2021. However, tools of this kind gained prominence after ChatGPT was launched. Suddenly, hundreds of AI-based tools came into the spotlight. Let us take a look at some of them.

The first one is Bard, developed by Google and launched in March 2023. It is a chatbot based on the LaMDA family of large language models and aims to compete with ChatGPT. However, as of April 2023, Bard is not yet available in India. In my observation, ChatGPT provides

only subpar performance while answering advanced mathematical questions — not simple arithmetic. Therefore, I am eagerly waiting to compare Bard with ChatGPT. Bard is just the beginning — almost every tech giant has announced or introduced chatbots to compete with ChatGPT. Let us discuss a few more of them. LLaMA (Large Language Model Meta AI) is a large language model developed by Meta (Facebook). Although launched in February 2023, you have to request access and wait to use LLaMA. This is another tool I am eagerly waiting to try out.

IBM Watson from IBM and Ernie Bot from Baidu are two other potential competitors to ChatGPT. Additionally, tools like Amazon